

## Looking of Any Old chicks

Any-old chicks of good quality should be looked ahead of time from reliable source before embarking on sanitation and cleaning of the poultry house.

The quality of chick is very important factor to consider in poultry production. Poor performances are often linked to substandard or poor quality chick.

\* Chick of good quality ~~of~~ must satisfy the following criteria;

- 1) Absence of any sign of stress such as panting, weakness.
- 2) Alert and interested in its environment and responding well to sound or external stimulus.
- 3) Clear and bright eyes
- 4) Clean, dry and free from dirt and contamination
- 5) Free from deformities.
- 6) Firm body to touch.
- 7) Normal conformation of legs, no loose scaling, skin lesions. etc
- 8) Straight legs
- 9) Well-formed hard beaks.

- (4) Management is easy such as reduced feed waste, prevention and control of disease etc.

#### \* Advantages

- (1) Housing and equipments are expensive
- (2) Cage fatigue is prominent
- (3) It is labour intensive
- (4) Only table eggs are produced.

#### Management of Day-Old Chicks (Preparation for the arrival of Day old chicks)

- Fill the cracks on the wall and floor.
- Clean the ceilings on the roof, down to the floor.
- Wash and disinfect the pen.
- The cleaning process must be done / complete one week before the arrival of the chicks.
- Two days to the arrival of the chicks, all equipments must be available and fully functional.
- Litter material is introduced 2 days to the arrival of the chicks so as to control the dust, to settle.
- 2-3 hours before the arrival of the birds, heating process commences. The feeders and drinkers are laid alternatively.
- Observe the birds. Check guard is to confine the birds in the brooding area.
- Brooding can be discontinued after 2-3 weeks depending on the time of the year.
- After brooding, change the litter and disinfect the birds.

## ADULT ROOSTING MEASURES PREVENTIVES

- \* During the first one week, inspect your birds as frequent as possible especially in the mornings, evenings and occasionally at any other times to ensure that birds are comfortable.
- \* Remove Moldy or Contaminated Feed and add fresh feeds.
- \* Always wash drinkers before refilling with water that is fit for human consumption.
- \* Always keep the surroundings clean
- \* If abnormal signs such as reduction in feed intake, bloody feces, yellowish and whitish diarrhea are observed consult a veterinary or livestock officer.
- \* Always remove wet litter material in a poultry house
- \* Remove saturated litter material. Saturated litter material can be known when the ammonia odor becomes too much in the house creaking discomfort to both the farmers and birds. Birds are often seen to hang around windows of the house.
- \* Change litter material when there is outbreak of disease or ectoparasite infestation.

# POULTRY MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

\* EXTENSIVE SYSTEM: This system is also known as free range or scavenging system. The birds find appreciable amount of feed in the surroundings during the day and take shelter in a house during the night. This system is not suitable for commercial farming.

## Advantages:

- ① It is ~~cheaf~~ cheaper and easy to start up.
- ② It requires little or no technical skill
- ③ It is good for those that have a lot of space
- ④ Minimum cost of rearing.

## Disadvantages

- ① No proper record keeping
- ② Loss of birds to predators
- ③ Losses of eggs may be a problem because the hen lays eggs here and there.
- ④ Management practice is poor.
- ⑤ The birds are prone to diseases

\* SEMI-INTENSIVE SYSTEM: This system is adopted where the amount of free space is limited. The poultry house is run in a small land surrounded by wire mesh.

## \* Advantages

- 1) Birds are protected against predators.
- 2) Movement on fresh grounds is opportune.

## \* Disadvantages

- 1) easy spread of diseases
- 2) The run may be littered with the droppings.

\* Intensive system: This is a system where adequate shelter and feed are provided to the birds. The birds are kept inside the pen throughout and it can be of two types.

- 1) Deep litter system.
- 2) Battery cage system.

\* Deep litter system: This system is widely used in commercial farms and scientific research farms. The birds are raised on the concrete floor covered with wood shavings. The wood shavings absorb moisture in poultry droppings and water spilled. The litter materials such as rice husk, groundnut shells or saw dust can be used depending on the availability.

## \* Advantages

1) The litter reduces dampness of the floor

\* It is suitable for raising large number of birds especially growers.

- \* It is cheaper compared to battery cage system.
- \* It provides safety against predators.
- \* It saves labour as daily cleaning is not required.
- \* It provides valuable fertiliser.

### \* Advantages

1. Easy spread of diseases.
2. Wastage of feeds.
3. Cannibalism is prominent.
4. Eggs laid on deep litter are usually dirty.
5. It encourages egg eating.

### \* BATTERY CAGE SYSTEM

This is a system where birds are confined in a cage just large enough to permit very limited movement and allow the bird to stand and sit comfortably. The floor is made up with pulverized lime and a system to wash the droppings collected which depends on the type of cage involved. The feeder and waterer remain outside of the cage.

### \* Advantages

1. Allows better flock supervision
2. Performance of each bird can be monitored and culling is easy when required.
3. Clean and uniform egg production throughout the year is possible.

①+ Management is easy such as reduced feed wastage.  
Prevention and control of disease etc.

x Advantages

- ① Housing and equipments are expensive
- ② Cope fatigue is prominent
- ③ It is labour intensive
- ④ Only table eggs are produced

Broiler chickens should be fed and watered ad libitum. Feeders should be constantly raised to the level of their backs to prevent feed wastage.

### Management of Growers

Chickens that are between 8-20 weeks of age are referred to as growers. The main objective is to manage them so that they start laying in good condition. The objectives of managing birds during the grower stage are to:

1. Maintain good health and vigorous growth
2. Maintain fairly uniform growth in body weight
3. To have low mortality of about 5%
4. To make pullets start laying at the expected age 18-20 weeks.
5. Raise them in such a way that while laying, they will peak at a high rate as possible in age production (85%) and above and also reach the peak in good time within 4-6 weeks of laying.
6. Keep daily records of feed intake, bird population and health conditions.
7. Remove dead birds and promptly provide adequate treatment.
8. Wean birds especially between 10-12 weeks. Avoid checking birds after 16 weeks, if there is no pecking because such period is too close to the laying period.



## Requirements of Layers

Adequate Management leads to maximum egg production from birds while disease outbreaks, parasites and mortality are minimal. Good management in layers often reduces poultry vices such as egg eating, cannibalism, fighting. Preparations before laying: Preparations usually starts from 16 weeks and include the following:

- ① Vaccination, ~~de~~teaching and deworming. Administer a dose of Newcastle Disease vaccine at 16 weeks
- ② Transfer pullet to the laying house or cage between 16-18 weeks and not later to prevent stress close to laying period.
- ③ Installation of laying nest is usually done at 18 weeks.
- ④ Feeding: Layers mash or pelleted layer diet should be fed to the birds after the birds have attained 5% level of egg production. When pullets starts laying, they usually eat much because they are simultaneously growing in size.

# Investment Opportunities in Poultry Production

- 1) Breed and sell
- 2) Breiler chicken production
- 3) Started Pullet Production
- 4) Cockerel Production
- 5) Point-of-lay production
- 6) Breeder farming
- 7) Marketing of day old chicks
- 8) Marketing of spent layers
- 9) Marketing of manure

## Records keeping

There are different records that a farmer can keep. The choice depends on the level of organisation and the farmer.

- 1) Production record
- 2) Mortality/Casualty record
- 3) Cost of Production record
- 4) Sales Record

# Sample Record

① An example of cost of production record

| Activities / Items | Quantity | Rate | Amount |
|--------------------|----------|------|--------|
|                    |          |      |        |
|                    |          |      |        |
|                    |          |      |        |
|                    |          |      |        |
|                    |          |      |        |

② An example of material quantity record

| Opening  | Closing                |               | Balance |             |
|----------|------------------------|---------------|---------|-------------|
| Op Stock | Quantity / Materiality | Closing Stock | Issued  | Materiality |
| 200      | —                      | 200           | 1 kg    | —           |
|          |                        |               |         |             |
|          |                        |               |         |             |
|          |                        |               |         |             |

③ An example of sales record

| Material / Dept | Quantity | Rate | Total |
|-----------------|----------|------|-------|
|                 | 3        | 5000 | 15000 |
|                 |          |      |       |
|                 |          |      |       |
|                 |          |      |       |

# ④ An example of Production Record

| ATZ | No. of<br>Stock | 1 <sup>st</sup><br>Collection | 2 <sup>nd</sup><br>Collection | 3 <sup>rd</sup><br>Collection | Total no.<br>Crates / Pcs |
|-----|-----------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|---------------------------|
|     | 150             | 62 Pcs                        | 48 Pcs                        | 13 Pcs                        | 4 Crates, 3 Pcs           |
|     |                 |                               |                               |                               |                           |
|     |                 |                               |                               |                               |                           |
|     |                 |                               |                               |                               |                           |

## Incubation ~~period~~ of a Hatchery Management

Incubation is the Management of a fertilized egg to ensure the satisfactory development of the embryo inside it into a normal chick.  
Incubation may be achieved by the natural method with a hen sitting on the eggs or by using special machines known as incubators. These are placed in special building known as hatchery.

## Incubation and Hatching Management

Incubation and hatching management is an important aspect of the poultry industry that ensures steady supply of day-old chicks for continuous rearing of poultry birds.

### Incubation Period of Some Poultry Species

| Species | Incubation Period |
|---------|-------------------|
| Chicken | 20-21             |
| Turkey  | 26-28             |
| Duck    | 26-28             |
| Pigeon  | 17-19             |
| Ostrich | 40-42             |